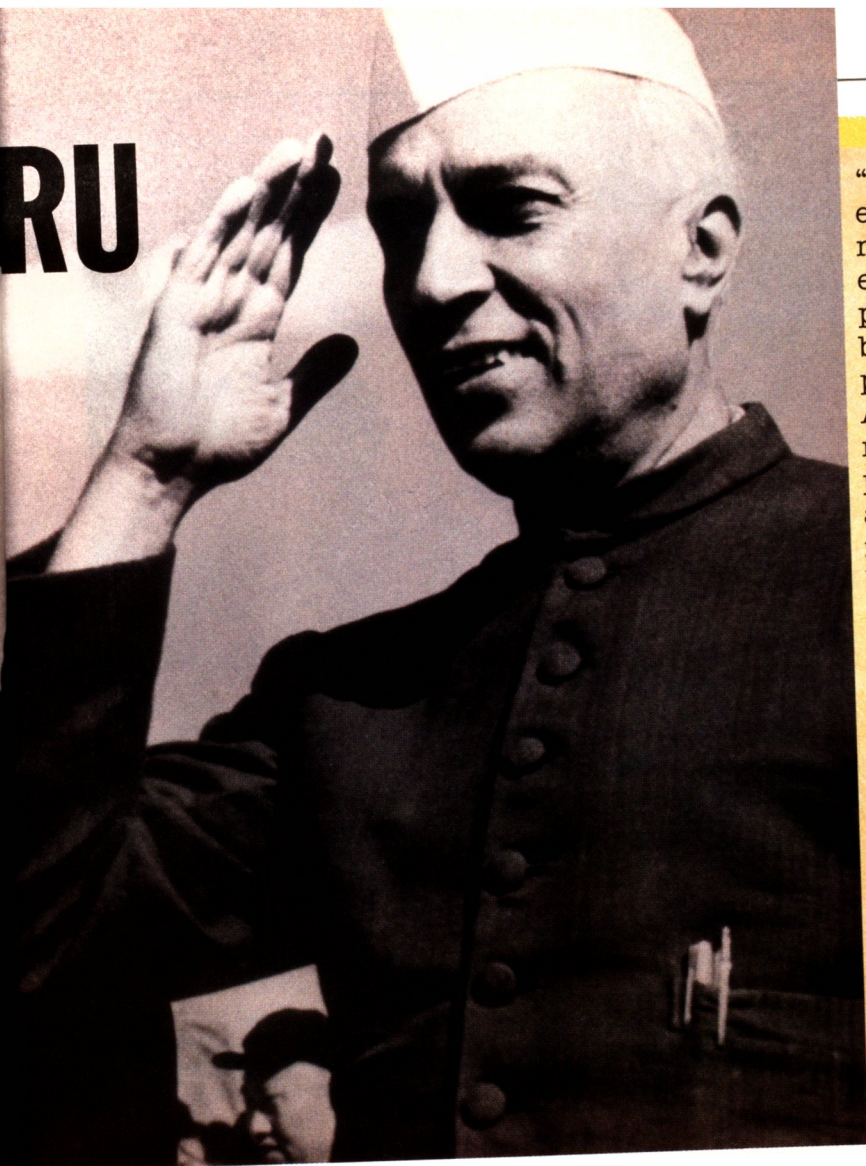


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CIA REPORT

"The Chinese diplomatic effort was a five-year masterpiece of guile, executed and probably planned in large part by Chou en Lai. Chou played on Nehru's Asian, anti-imperialist mental attitude, his proclivity to temporise and his sincere desire for an amicable Sino-Indian relationship."

"Nehru told a source: In certain circumstances I would not have minded giving away a little bit of Ladakh, presumably the Aksai Plain. But I do not want the Chinese to take me for a sucker. Chou en Lai has lied to me so often that I do not feel like trusting him anymore."

attitude that of a feeling of superiority to the Chinese."

More than that it was Nehru's personal prestige as a leading Asian leader that played on the Chinese strategic thinking and the paper argues that one of the Chinese leaders' priorities was to seriously damage Nehru's prestige and credibility. Interestingly, the papers reveal the Chinese mindset was aimed at

humiliating the Indians. According to an Indian foreign office note of 1959 quoted by the CIA: "The Vice Foreign Minister indulged in personal attacks against Indian Prime Minister Nehru, Defence Minister Krishna Menon and Secretary-General R.K. Nehru...Liao charged the Prime Minister of India with dishonest dealing." In fact, when the Secretary General to the Ministry of

External Affairs (MEA) R.K. Nehru went to Beijing, he was badly humiliated by the Chinese. The papers say: "The MEA Secretary-General, R.K. Nehru was scolded like a small boy by Liao Shao-Chi in July 1961 for coming to China only to demand a Chinese withdrawal."

While on one hand the Chinese played on Nehru, they also used the Indian communists to discredit him. As the papers reveal: "Chinese diplomats were tasked to play up through the Indian communists that Nehru was pro US. He is Kennedy's lawyer, a Chinese diplomat told a senior Indian communist." The papers also disclose that Nehru wanted to have a deal on Aksai Chin, in exchange of the Indian ownership of Arunachal Pradesh, which, interestingly, continues to be a bone of

1959: Dalai Lama escapes from Tibet, India gives asylum. China refuses to accept the McMahon line. Chinese troops kill nine Indian soldiers and capture 10 in Aksai Chin.

1960: Pushed by Khrushchev, Chou en Lai meets Nehru in Delhi. Talks end in a deadlock.

1961: Border skirmishes intensify.



Nikita Khrushchev

1962: China captures Bomdilla and then announces an unilateral ceasefire.

1962: Colombo proposals negotiated between Nehru and Chou en Lai.